Electronics and
Computer Science

UNIVERSITY OF
Southampton

Literature Summary

Report Subject: Usable Computing Systems

(Note: Full references are listed at the end due to Zotero only allowing one Bibliography)

Name: Andrew Milne
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Paper 1: Full Reference (Initiative (WAI), 2016)
What indicates the quality of this paper? The author is part of a standards agency, which is a known authority in this area. Additionally, as a result of the author being part of a standards agency, this has likely been peer reviewed.
How will this paper support the argument you are making? It clearly defines and describes accessibility, usability and inclusion with regards to web design and UX, as well as the standards regarding them, which is a significant factor that my report needs to cover. As a result of being directly sourced from a standards agency, this is a key source regarding that. Furthermore, it provides a detailed list of issues that can hinder these defined objectives. This can be used as a base line and a jumping off point to discuss specific elements in further detail.
Paper 2: Full Reference ("Understanding accessibility requirements for public sector bodies," 2023)
What indicates the quality of this paper? This has been produced by the government and was last updated in October of this year.
How will this paper support the argument you are making? While this is specifically referring to legal requirements for public sector bodies regarding accessibility in web pages, measures that improve web page accessibility for them will also improve accessibility in web pages run by the private sector. Pages linked in this – essentially acting as references – also explain how measures to improve accessibility are evolving over time, which can be used to support the argument that websites must be checked periodically to ensure that they are up to date (or, if possible, ahead of the curve) on the latest standards and conventions.
Paper 3: Full Reference (Issa and Isaias, 2022)

What indicates the quality of this paper?

This is part of a peer-reviewed textbook on the subject published in 2022, whose authors have published multiple works in this area.

How will this paper support the argument you are making?

It describes human-computer interaction, both in the past and present, and how to implement or improve it in web pages. It also does the same for usability, though does not mention how it was considered in the past. Additionally, it explains why these are important for web pages. Additionally, this can be used to help link together human-computer interaction and usability. For example, one of the goals of human-computer interaction is to "produce usable and safe systems" (Issa and Isaias, 2022), while a usability specification helps to define what the term usable means with regards to the context provided.

Initiative (WAI), W.W.A., 2016. Accessibility, Usability, and Inclusion [WWW Document]. Web Access. Initiat. WAI. URL https://www.w3.org/WAI/fundamentals/accessibility-usability-inclusion/ (accessed 11.19.23).

Issa, T., Isaias, P., 2022. Usability and Human–Computer Interaction (HCI), in: Issa, T., Isaias, P. (Eds.), Sustainable Design: HCI, Usability and Environmental Concerns. Springer, London, pp. 23–40. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-1-4471-7513-1_2

Understanding accessibility requirements for public sector bodies [WWW Document], 2023. . GOV.UK. URL https://www.gov.uk/guidance/accessibility-requirements-for-public-sector-websites-and-apps (accessed 11.19.23).